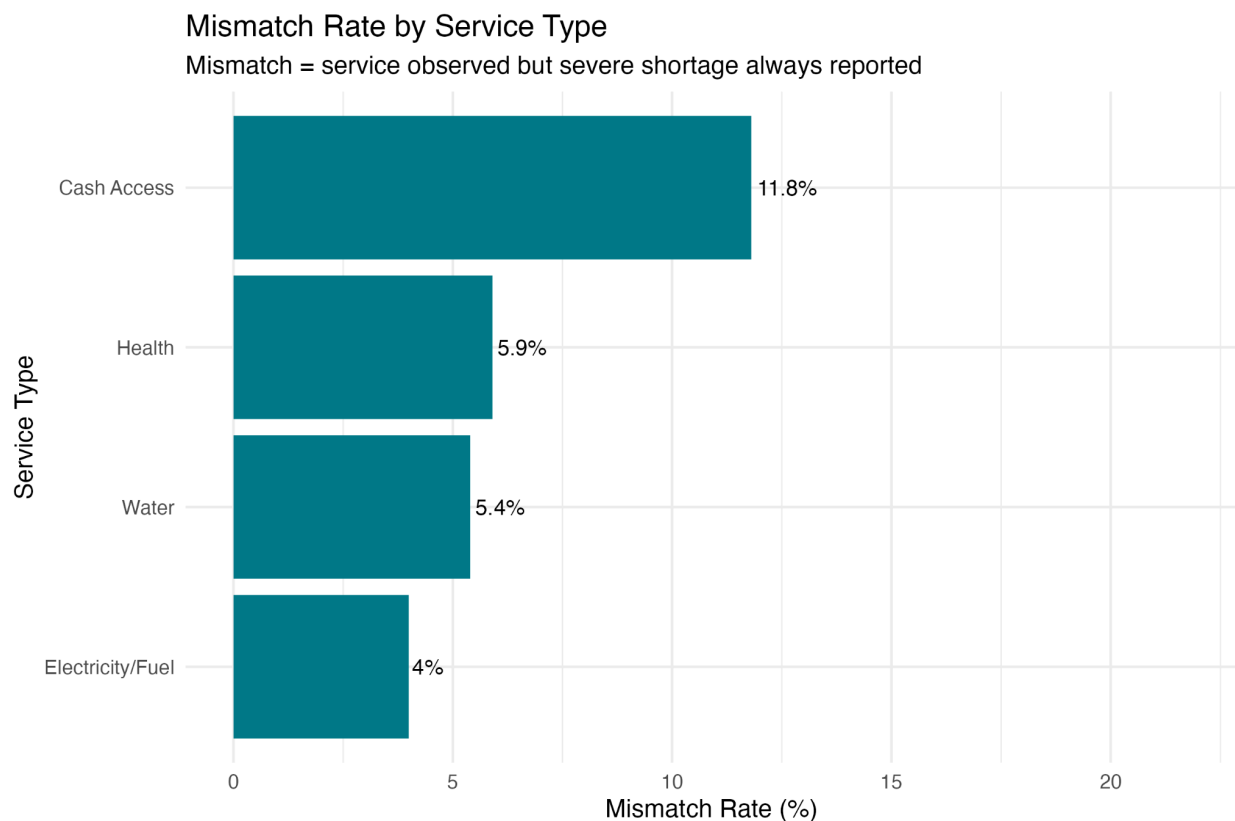


6. Visualizations

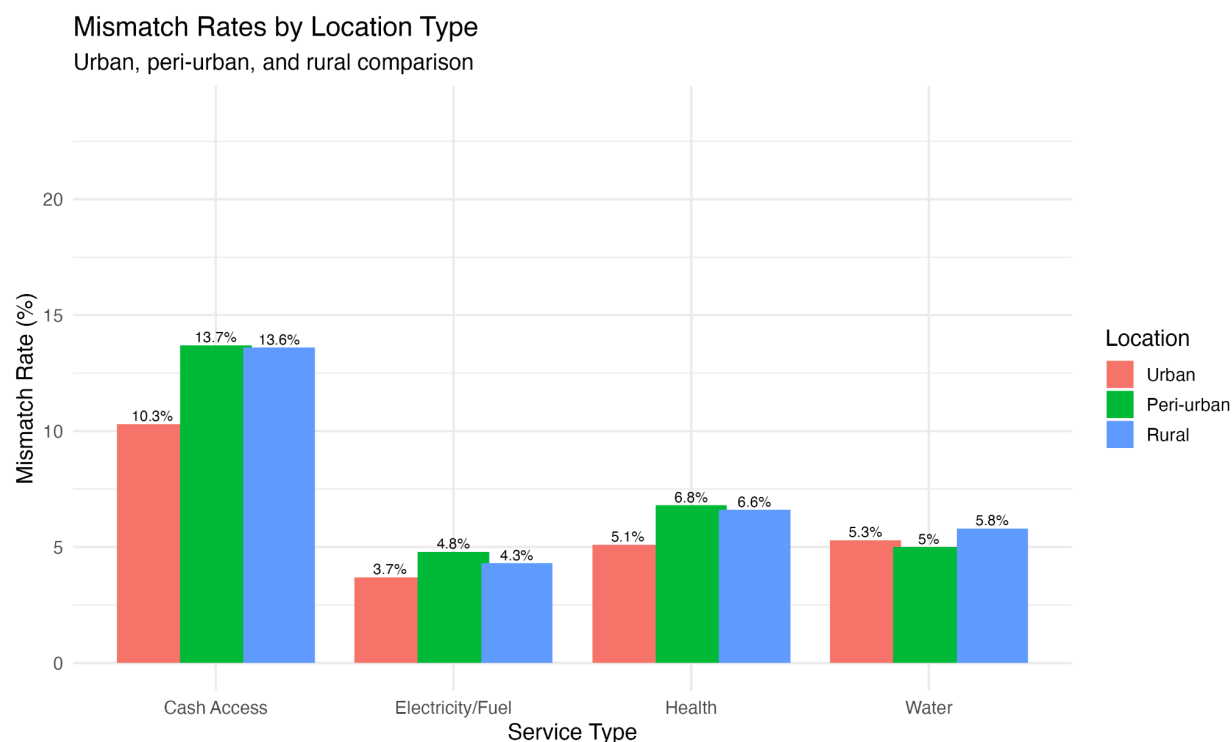
6.1 Overall Service Visibility Mismatch

Figure 6.1 presents the overall mismatch rates across the four service categories. Cash access records the highest mismatch rate at **11.8%**, indicating that a notable proportion of respondents continued to experience severe cash shortages despite having access to banks, ATMs, or mobile money services within their communities. Health (5.9%) and water (5.4%) exhibit moderate levels of mismatch, while electricity/fuel records the lowest mismatch rate at **4.0%**. These findings suggest that financial services experience the greatest disconnect between infrastructure availability and actual household access, whereas electricity and fuel services show the smallest mismatch under the stricter definition of severe shortage.



6.2 Urban–Rural Service Differences

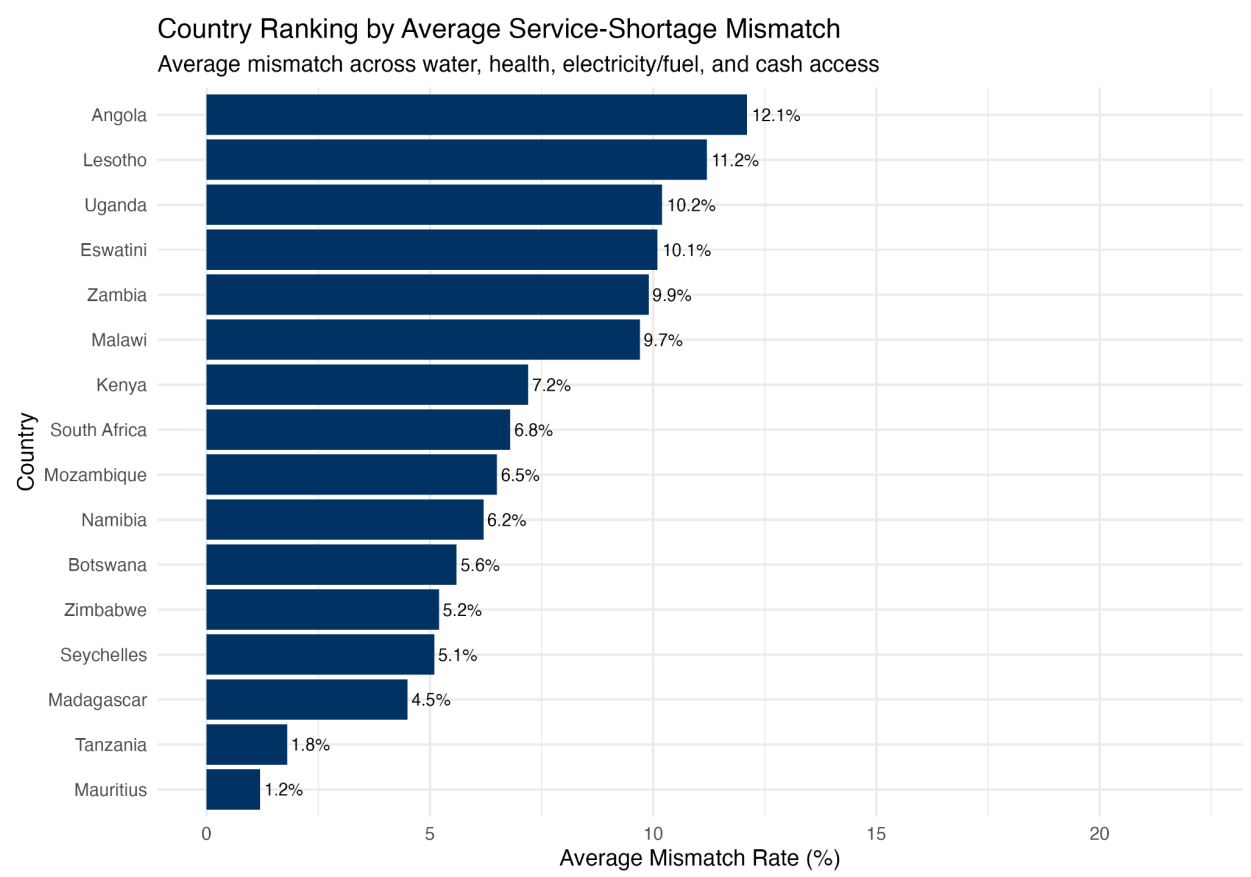
Figure 6.2 compares mismatch rates across urban, peri-urban, and rural areas. Cash access exhibits the highest mismatch across all settlement types, reaching **13.7%** in peri-urban areas and **13.6%** in rural areas, compared with **10.3%** in urban areas. Health mismatches are also more common outside urban centres, with rates of **6.8%** in peri-urban areas and **6.6%** in rural areas, compared with **5.1%** in urban locations. Water mismatches remain relatively similar across locations, ranging from **5.0%** to **5.8%**, while electricity/fuel mismatches are consistently the lowest, varying between **3.7%** and **4.8%**. Overall, the results suggest that service-shortage mismatches are generally more pronounced in peri-urban and rural communities than in urban areas.



6.3 Country Rankings

Figure 6.3 ranks the sixteen countries according to their average mismatch across water, health, electricity/fuel, and cash access. **Angola** records the highest overall mismatch (**12.1%**), followed by **Lesotho (11.2%)**, **Uganda (10.2%)**, **Eswatini (10.1%)**, and **Zambia (9.9%)**. These countries exhibit relatively large gaps between observed

infrastructure and reported access to essential services. At the opposite end of the distribution, **Mauritius** records the lowest average mismatch (**1.2%**), followed by **Tanzania (1.8%)** and **Madagascar (4.5%)**, indicating comparatively better alignment between infrastructure availability and household experiences. These rankings provide an overall measure of service delivery performance and help identify countries where infrastructure investments appear least effective in translating into reliable service access.



6.4 Service Hotspots Across Countries

Figure 6.4 illustrates how mismatch rates vary across both countries and service categories. Darker cells indicate higher mismatch rates. Cash access emerges as the dominant source of mismatch across most countries, with particularly high values in **Lesotho (27.1%)**, **Uganda (21.1%)**, **Malawi (20.8%)**, and **Zambia (16.3%)**. In contrast, health mismatches are especially pronounced in **Zambia (14.5%)**, **Angola (12.0%)**, and **Eswatini (10.6%)**, while water mismatches are highest in **Angola (13.3%)** and **Eswatini (10.3%)**. Electricity/fuel generally records the lowest mismatch rates across

the region, although relatively elevated values remain visible in Angola, Uganda, and Eswatini. Overall, the heatmap highlights substantial cross-country and cross-sector variation, demonstrating that the relationship between infrastructure availability and effective service delivery differs considerably across Southern African countries.

